



- The **suffix -y acts as a vowel**, so, if adding it to words ending in a silent -e, drop the silent -e. For example, *ice* becomes *icy* and *spice* becomes *spicy*.

GLOSSARY

Prefix A group of letters attached to the start of a word that can change the root word's meaning.

Root The smallest part of a word without a prefix or suffix attached.

Suffix A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the root word's meaning.

Syllable A unit of pronunciation that has one vowel sound.

Words ending in -y

Words that end in -y can also change spelling when a suffix is added. The main factor that determines this spelling change is whether the final -y is preceded by a consonant or a vowel.

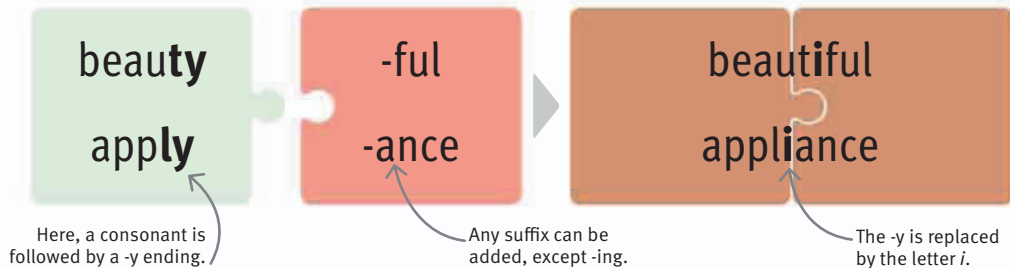
▷ Exceptions

Like words ending in -e, there are exceptions to the rules for words ending in -y.

Root word	Suffix	New word
day	-ly	daily
dry	-ness	dryness
shy	-ly	shyly
shy	-ness	shyness
sly	-ly	slyly
sly	-ness	slyness

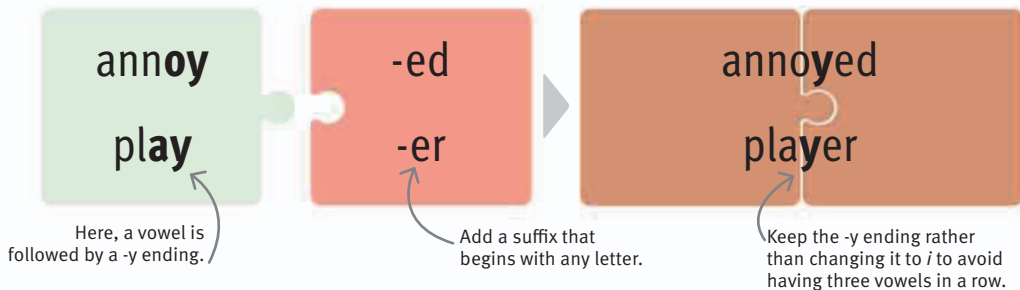
▷ Rule 1

If a word ends in a consonant and -y, the -y is replaced by *i* when any suffix except for -ing is added.



▷ Rule 2

If a word ends in a -y preceded by a vowel, the -y is kept when a suffix is added.



▷ Rule 3

If a word ends in a -y, the -y is kept when the suffix -ing is added.

